

METRO AG SCI Project: Scope to Indicators

Scope

Scope statement

This project examines METRO AG's customer-facing digital services for professional HoReCa customers in Europe, with a focus on its e-commerce ordering platform and mobile commerce app, in order to assess how these capabilities contribute to customer retention and competitive positioning over a 3–5 year horizon.

Out of scope

Internal digital tools, logistics systems, supplier-side software, credit management, invoicing workflows, and other non-customer-facing technologies are excluded.

Key Intelligence Topics

Category	KIT
KIT 1 — Strategic decisions & actions	Effectiveness of METRO AG's digital ordering channels in supporting customer retention and customer convenience in the European HoReCa market.
KIT 2 — Early warning	Emerging changes in customer expectations, competitor strategies, and digital service trends affecting METRO AG's digital positioning over the next 3–5 years.
KIT 3 — Key players & positioning	Competitive positioning of METRO AG's e-commerce platform and mobile commerce app relative to traditional and digital-native players in the European HoReCa sector.

Key Intelligence Questions and Indicators

KIT 1 — Strategic decisions & actions

KIQ	Indicators
KIQ 1.1 What functionalities and services do METRO's e-commerce platform and mobile app offer to support ordering and customer interaction?	Product search and filtering functions; order placement and reorder functions; delivery or click-and-collect options; customer account and order history features.
KIQ 1.2 How have METRO's digital ordering channels evolved over the past 3–5 years in terms of features, usability, and service scope?	Launch announcements of new functions; app version updates or release notes; new service categories added to the platform; public statements about digital transformation or multichannel expansion.

KIQ	Indicators
KIQ 1.3 How do METRO's digital ordering channels contribute to customer retention, as reflected in repeat use, convenience, and loyalty signals?	Customer reviews mentioning repeated use; reviews mentioning convenience or ease of ordering; repeat-order or reorder features; loyalty program references or saved preferences.
KIQ 1.4 What are the main strengths and weaknesses of METRO's digital ordering channels from a customer perspective?	Positive app-store review themes; negative app-store review themes; complaints about usability or bugs; praise for convenience, speed, or product range.

KIT 2 — Early warning

KIQ	Indicators
KIQ 2.1 What emerging digital trends are shaping ordering behavior in the HoReCa sector?	News articles on AI ordering tools; mentions of personalization or recommendation engines; mobile-first ordering solutions; trade press coverage of ordering innovation.
KIQ 2.2 How are competitors evolving their digital ordering capabilities?	Competitor product launches; app updates or platform upgrades; new e-commerce features; partnerships with tech providers.
KIQ 2.3 Are new digital-native players or platforms entering METRO's customer segment?	Launch of new B2B ordering platforms; market entry announcements; funding rounds for digital-native competitors; marketplace-style platforms targeting HoReCa.
KIQ 2.4 What changes in customer expectations, such as speed, personalization, and ease of use, are influencing digital ordering behavior?	Review themes mentioning speed and convenience; demand for one-click reordering or saved baskets; complaints about slow or complex interfaces; sector surveys on digital buying preferences.

KIT 3 — Key players & positioning

KIQ	Indicators
KIQ 3.1 Who are the main competitors offering digital ordering solutions to HoReCa customers in Europe?	Competitor websites and product pages; industry reports naming key players; app store presence of competitor ordering tools; analyst comparisons of competitive sets.
KIQ 3.2 How do competitors' digital ordering platforms differ from METRO's in terms of features, usability, and service quality?	Feature comparison across websites or apps; app-store ratings and reviews; public demos or screenshots; differences in delivery, pickup, or support services.
KIQ 3.3 What competitive advantages and gaps can be identified in METRO's digital ordering channels compared to key players?	METRO feature set versus competitor feature set; comparative customer ratings; evidence of missing features compared with rivals; public statements about differentiation.
KIQ 3.4 How do customers perceive METRO's digital services compared to competitors' digital services?	Review sentiment mentioning competitor comparisons; customer testimonials; forum or social media comments; review language about switching or preference.